



Dreamcatcher

PREPARED FOR KRISTIN SCHOOL

The Ark Naming System

A shared language for durable student-owned AI: Ark, Steward, Conscience, Covenant, Vault, Codex, Ledger, Engines, and Ports.

Prepared by Tom Thompson · tom@DreamCatcher.ai

Parent of Harry Thompson (Junior School applicant, unconfirmed)

NAMING DECISION

Choose Ark.
Core is architecture.
Ark is a thing.

Why Ark lands

It carries precious continuity. It is durable, portable, protected, and specific enough to talk about in ordinary language.

custody

protection

carriage

continuity

ownership

THE PROBLEM WITH OLD NAMES

Core

Technically useful, but generic. It sounds like an implementation detail.

Container

Correct but bland. It misses the preciousness and the machinery inside.

Universe

Captures “everythingness,” but loses bounded custody and can sound too vast.

Ark says: this is the durable vessel the student can carry forward.

ONE-PAGE NAMING MAP

The Ark is the thing. The Steward works inside it.

A portable personal vessel with an active agent, a safety boundary, a governing covenant, and open ports for leaving with it.

CONTAINER

Ark

Durable, portable, student-owned vessel. Precious continuity, not another app account.

ACTIVE AGENT

Steward

The agent/persona working inside the Ark. Models can change; stewardship persists.

INNER RECORD

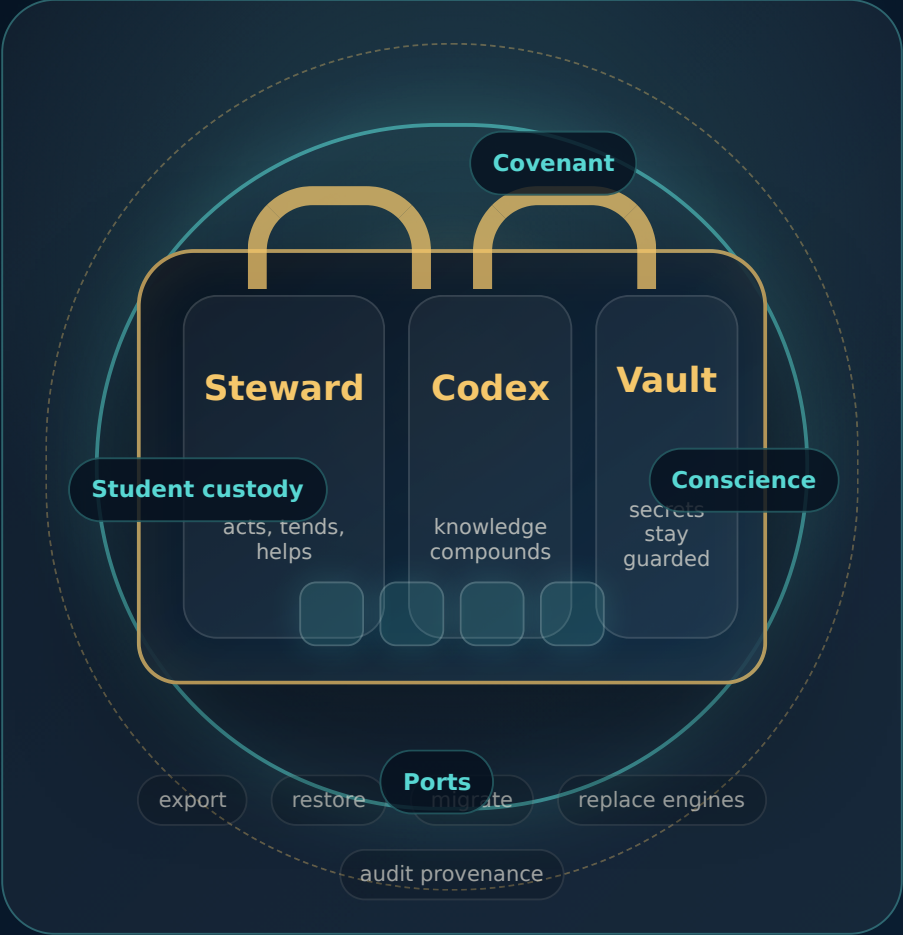
Codex

Living knowledge: projects, feedback, reflections, values, evidence, and learning history.

SECURE CHAMBER

Vault

Keys, credentials, recovery, money rails, and high-risk permissions.



SAFETY BOUNDARY

Conscience

Interprets rules, explains blocks, and governs flows across the Ark boundary.

PROMISES

Covenant

Who may see, contribute, steer, recover, escalate, or certify what.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Ledger

Provenance: what happened, why, whose influence, and how to reverse it.

REPLACEABLE POWER

Engines + Ports

Models, tools, and connectors can change. The Ark must move with the student.

THE ARK

A protected enduring vessel.

The Ark is the student-owned place where knowledge, tools, memory, values, and agency accumulate.

How to say it

- “Every student has an Ark.”
- “The Ark belongs to the student, not the vendor.”
- “The school can certify and contribute without owning the Ark.”
- “A student can leave with their Ark.”

THE STEWARD

The active intelligence inside.

The Steward tends the Ark. It works for the student without becoming the owner.

Why this name

“Agent” is generic. “Worker” is too mechanical. “Daemon” is technically rich but risky for parents. Steward has the right duty: active care on behalf of someone else.

Common language

“Your Steward can change models over time, but your Ark keeps continuity.”

MODELS ARE ENGINES, NOT IDENTITY

What changes

AI models, tools, retrieval methods, memory systems, safety classifiers, and interfaces will all change over years.

model A

model B

local model

school-approved model

The Ark must outlast the engines.

The Steward can use
better engines without
making the student start
again.

THE CONSCIENCE

The boundary with judgement.

The Conscience governs what crosses the Ark boundary and explains why.

It checks

- school rules, family permissions, law, safety, privacy and cost;
- what the Steward may do;
- what parents or teachers may see;
- when escalation is required.

THE COVENANT

Not the container

The Covenant is not the Ark. It is the promise around the Ark: who may steer, see, certify, recover, contribute, or intervene.

School phrase

“The Covenant defines how school, family, student, and system share responsibility.”

The Ark is owned. The Covenant is agreed.

This keeps care from becoming surveillance.

VAULT AND CODEX

Vault

The hardened inner chamber: credentials, keys, money rails, biometric recovery, export permissions and other high-risk controls.

Phrase: “That belongs in the Vault.”

Codex

The living body of knowledge: learning evidence, reflections, projects, feedback, mistakes, values, preferences, and school-certified records.

Phrase: “The Codex is how knowledge compounds.”

LEDGER AND PORTS

Ledger

Provenance and accountability: what happened, why it happened, whose influence shaped it, what model/tool was used, and how to audit or reverse it.

Ports

Export, import, restore, migrate, connect, and leave. Ports prove the Ark is portable and not a corporate prison.

Ownership is not a slogan until the student can move the Ark.

STUDENT OWNERSHIP

Portable by design.

The Ark must be open enough to leave with, restore elsewhere, and survive the school/vendor/tool stack changing.

Proof points

- export and restore drills;
- open source or open protocol where possible;
- replaceable engines and tools;
- clear custody and recovery rights;
- deletion and revocation that actually work.

HOW PEOPLE SHOULD TALK

Ordinary language matters.

School

“We are piloting student Arks, tuning the Conscience, and agreeing the Covenant with families.”

Parent

“I can contribute to my child’s Ark without taking it over.”

Student

“This is my Ark. My Steward helps me. The Conscience tells me why something is blocked.”

HOW IT FITS EXISTING DECKS

Old language

- enduring core
- durable core
- child core
- parent core
- container / capsule

New language

- student Ark
- parent Ark
- school Ark
- simulated-student Ark
- portable Ark

Keep “core/container” only when explaining the underlying architecture. Public language should lead with Ark.

REFERENCE SENTENCE

Every child needs an Ark, not another app.

A durable personal Ark where knowledge, tools, memory, values and agency can accumulate; a Steward works inside it, a Conscience guards its boundary, and a Covenant defines how family and school share responsibility.

CLOSING VOCABULARY

Protect the Ark.

Durability, custody, portability,
continuity.

Train the Steward.

Help, action, memory, model
changes without identity loss.

Tune the Conscience.

Safety, visibility, explanation,
escalation.

Honor the Covenant.